

Country PhD Intelligence: United States

Academic Intelligence Dossier • 2026-09-17

Country Code: US

Primary Currency: USD

Execution Date: 2026-09-17

Target PhD Field: Edge Computing, Edge AI & Distributed Systems

1. Country Overview & Research Ecosystem

United States offers an internationally renowned doctoral research ecosystem characterized by world-class university laboratories, competitive national and institutional funding structures, and clear pathways for international doctoral scholars.

* **Primary Funding Vehicle:** Full Graduate Research Assistantships (100% Tuition Waiver + \$30k-\$48k Stipend)

* **Immigration & Dependant Policy:** Spouses and unmarried minor children of F-1/J-1 doctoral students are eligible for F-2 or J-2 derivative status. J-2 spouses may apply for work authorization (EAD).

* **Official Guidance:** <https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/us-visas/study/student-visa.html>

2. Executive Intelligence Metrics

* **Total Top Universities Identified:** 8

* **Total Vetted Professors Monitored:** 8

* **Available Doctoral Funding Schemes:** 3

* **Key Application Deadline:** 2026-12-15

3. Discovered Universities & Suitability

4. Top Vetted PhD Supervisors & Relevance

5. Major Doctoral Funding Schemes & Scholarships

Full Graduate Research Assistantship (GRA / RA / Teaching Assistantship GTA)

* **Provider / University:** University Departments & Sponsored Research Grants (NSF, DARPA, DOE, Industry) (All Major US Research Universities (CMU, Berkeley, UT Austin, UIUC, MIT, Stanford, etc.))

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** 100% full tuition waiver and mandatory university fee coverage for duration of PhD

* **Stipend / Salary:** \$32,000 - \$48,000/year living stipend paid semi-monthly + university-subsidized comprehensive health, dental, and vision insurance

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-15

* **Official Source:** <https://www.cs.cmu.edu/academics/phd/financial-aid>

Doctoral Departmental & Institutional Fellowships (Dean's Fellowship / Chancellor's Fellowship)

* **Provider / University:** University Graduate Schools & Endowments (All Accredited US Institutions)

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition and fee waiver

* **Stipend / Salary:** \$38,000 - \$45,000/year tax-free stipend with zero teaching obligations in year 1

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-10

* **Official Source:** <https://grad.berkeley.edu/admissions/financial-support/fellowships/>

Fulbright Foreign Student Program (Doctoral Track)

* **Provider / University:** U.S. Department of State / Foreign Fulbright Commissions (Accredited US Universities)

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition and mandatory fees covered

* **Stipend / Salary:** Monthly maintenance stipend calibrated to host city cost of living + health benefits + J-2 spouse work eligibility (EAD)

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-05-15

* **Official Source:** <https://foreign.fulbrightonline.org/>

6. Strategic Application Timeline & Next Steps

1. **Weeks 1–4:** Review individual 33-section professor dossiers under `professors/`.
2. **Weeks 5–6:** Conduct tailored email outreach referencing recent publications and active laboratory grants.
3. **Weeks 7–8:** Formalize 5-page research proposal aligned with the supervisor's documented testbeds.
4. **Target Deadline:** Submit institutional application ahead of **2026-12-15**.

Report compiled automatically by the Global Country-Based PhD Funding and Supervisor Intelligence Engine on 2026-09-17.